



Pack 02

Kids & co-parenting.

Two homes, one set of kids. Four tools to make handovers, messages and the week run smoother.

In this pack

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Weekly reset → Tool 13, in Pack 04.

Where it lives in the app

Week holds your fortnight and the before and after handover lists.

Scripts has the full message library, grouped by situation.

Records keeps the dated log and shared costs.

Run the list. Pack the bag.

Some handover stress is emotional. A lot of it is a forgotten hat. This fixes the hat.
Laminate it, or slip it in a plastic sleeve and use a whiteboard marker.

In the app: [Week](#) → your handover lists tick off on Today in the 2 days before a handover.

Names **A** _____ **B** _____ **C** _____

01 School essentials

Goes back tomorrow

	A	B	C
School uniform	☐	☐	☐
Hat	☐	☐	☐
Device	☐	☐	☐
Library books	☐	☐	☐
School bag packed	☐	☐	☐

	A	B	C
School shoes	☐	☐	☐
Homework	☐	☐	☐
Chargers	☐	☐	☐
Permission notes signed	☐	☐	☐
Lunch items organised	☐	☐	☐

02 Sports & activities

Check the week

	A	B	C
Sports uniform	☐	☐	☐
Water bottle	☐	☐	☐
Musical instrument	☐	☐	☐
Activity times checked	☐	☐	☐

	A	B	C
Sports shoes	☐	☐	☐
Equipment packed	☐	☐	☐
Dance or activity gear	☐	☐	☐
Transport confirmed	☐	☐	☐

03 Health & medication

Don't skip

	A	B	C
Medication packed and labelled	☐	☐	☐
Specialist appointments noted	☐	☐	☐

	A	B	C
Any allergy or medication change noted for the other home	☐	☐	☐
Scripts and refills checked	☐	☐	☐

04 Comfort & routine

Keep it steady

	A	B	C
Favourite comfort item	☐	☐	☐
Toiletries	☐	☐	☐
Weekend clothes	☐	☐	☐
Reading book, current chapter	☐	☐	☐

	A	B	C
Sleep toy or blanket	☐	☐	☐
Pyjamas	☐	☐	☐
Special event items	☐	☐	☐

Coming back is half the handover.

Unpack the same way every time, so nothing sits in a bag until the next handover. Older kids can own more of this than you'd expect.

05

Coming back

Within an hour of getting home

	A	B	C
School bag unpacked	☐	☐	☐
Medication back, dose noted	☐	☐	☐
Comfort item back in its place	☐	☐	☐
Sports gear aired out	☐	☐	☐

	A	B	C
Uniform in the wash	☐	☐	☐
Device and charger back	☐	☐	☐
Library books and notes back	☐	☐	☐
Anything missing written down	☐	☐	☐

Kids can own these.

For roughly 8 to 14

☐ Their own bag

☐ Device and charger

☐ Homework

☐ Their sports gear

06

Notes for the other home

Brief and practical

Only if you're in direct contact. If messages go through a lawyer, app or third party, use that. Keep facts only. Keep a copy. [In the app: Records →](#)

School updates

Schedule changes

Behaviour or sleep

Anything else worth knowing

“The goal is not perfect handovers.
The goal is reducing avoidable stress.”

Atlas field note

Safety first

These are for ordinary friction. If you feel unsafe, or there are threats or violence, you don't have to negotiate. Call 1800RESPECT on 1800 737 732, or 000 if you're in danger now.

Borrow the tone. Buy the time.

You don't need to sound perfect. You need to sound steady. Fill the [blanks] with specifics: vague messages get vague replies.

01 Schedule changes

Buying time

"Thanks for the message. Let me check the week and I'll come back to you by [time] tonight."

Conditional yes

"That change should be workable. I'll confirm by [time] once I've checked [school/transport]."

Soft no

"I can't do that switch this week. Would [day] work instead?"

02 Difficult messages

Pause the loop

"I'm going to stop here for tonight. I'll reply about [the pickup] by [time] tomorrow."

Acknowledge, redirect

"I can see this matters to you. On the practical part: [one line]."

Take a beat

"I've got this. I'll reply properly by [time]."

Before you send

The BIFF method, Bill Eddy

☐ Brief A few lines, one topic	☐ Informative Facts, not opinions	☐ Friendly A neutral opening line	☐ Firm A clear ask or answer
☐ Would you be comfortable with a mediator reading this later?			

Rough night? Danger now: 000. 1800RESPECT **1800 737 732** Lifeline **13 11 14** MensLine **1300 78 99 78**
Family Relationship Advice Line **1800 050 321** Kids Helpline **1800 55 1800**

Keep numbers visible. Keep kids central.

The two conversations that escalate fastest. Money goes calmer when you're both looking at the same numbers. Parenting decisions go calmer when the kids are the subject, not the argument.

03 Money conversations

Slow it down

"I'd prefer to look at the actual numbers before agreeing to [the change]."

Shared picture

"Let's write down the shared expenses for [month] so we're discussing the same information."

[In the app: Records, shared costs](#) →

No quick yes

"I'm not comfortable making a quick financial decision today. Send me the details and I'll reply by [day]."

04 Kids & parenting

Centre the children

"I think consistency will help [name] most right now."

Re-frame

"Can we focus on what creates the least disruption for the kids [this week]?"

Protect the audience

"Let's talk about this when the kids aren't around. Does [time] work?"

Talking to the kids

[Read more: get-atlas.com.au/how-to-tell-the-kids](https://get-atlas.com.au/how-to-tell-the-kids) →

Say

"This is a grown-up decision. It isn't because of anything you did."

Say

"Here's what happens this week: [who, where, when]."

Don't

Ask them to carry messages or money between homes.

Don't

Share adult details or blame, even when they ask.

Rough night? Danger now: 000. 1800RESPECT **1800 737 732** Lifeline **13 11 14** MensLine **1300 78 99 78**
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A boundary is just a repeated sentence.

You don't need a speech. You need one line you can use again next time, and the time after that. Steady beats clever.

05 Boundaries

Reusable

Logistics only

"I'm keeping our messages to the kids and logistics."

Keep it practical

"I'd prefer we keep this to [the practical issue]."

Not tonight

"I'm not available to continue this tonight. I'll reply by [time] tomorrow."

Which conversation keeps going badly? What's the one line you'll use next time?

Your line, in your words

"Borrow the tone. Borrow the line. Use it again."

Atlas field note

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Predictability helps them feel safer.

Two homes. One rhythm where you can. Bedtimes can differ between houses and kids cope. What they need is your house to be the same each time.

Names **A** _____ **B** _____ **C** _____

01 Morning routine

Task	A time	B time	C time
Wake up			
Breakfast			
School preparation			
Leave home			

02 Evening routine

Task	A time	B time	C time
Dinner			
Homework			
Screens off			
Bedtime			

03 Weekly structure

In the app: [Week](#) → set your fortnight pattern once

Day	Home	Key activities
Monday	☐ Mine ☐ Other home	
Tuesday	☐ Mine ☐ Other home	
Wednesday	☐ Mine ☐ Other home	
Thursday	☐ Mine ☐ Other home	
Friday	☐ Mine ☐ Other home	
Saturday	☐ Mine ☐ Other home	
Sunday	☐ Mine ☐ Other home	

Important info, in one place.

Fill it once. Keep one copy on your fridge. Share a copy with the other home only if it's safe and useful. Update it when something changes.

Name

A

B

C

01 School & care

School name			
Class teacher			
Front office			
Year coordinator			
Pickup arrangements			
OSHC / childcare			

02 Medical

GP			
Dentist			
Allergies			
Medications			
Specialist			
Emergency contact			

03 Activities & sizes

Sports & activities			
Music & tutoring			
Shoe size			
Clothing size			

Medicare card is kept

Parenting plan or orders are kept

**Kids don't need the same house twice.
They need the same you, each time.**

Two homes will run differently. That's fine. What helps is predictability in yours: the same bedtime, the same bag, the same way of saying goodbye.